Reading practice booklet: Grade 2 expectations

Grade 2 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Reading at Grade 2 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Draft: to be checked by a teacher before use.

Section 1: Sounds, letters and decoding

Standards practised: RF.2.3a, RF.2.3b, RF.2.3d, RF.2.3e, RF.2.3f, RF.2.4c

A worked example

Split the word "basket" into syllables.

1. Clap the word as you say it: bas-ket. You clap two times.
2. Each clap is one syllable, and each syllable has a vowel sound.

bas-ket (2 syllables)

Questions

1. Which word has the long e sound spelled with the vowel team "ea": bread, bead or bear?

2. Which vowel team is in the word "boat"?

3. Which word has the same vowel sound as "farm": cart, cat or cake?

4. Which word has the same vowel sound as "bird": hurt, hot or hat?

5. How many syllables are in the word "camel"?

6. Split the word "market" into its two syllables.

7. What is the prefix in the word "unlock"?

8. What is the suffix in the word "helpful"?

9. Which common word does not follow the usual sound pattern: said, sad or sand?

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10. Which word ends in the sound /t/ when you say the -ed ending: jumped, wanted or played?

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11. You read a sentence aloud and one word does not make sense. What should you do?

Section 2: Understanding what you read

Standards practised: RL.2.1, RL.2.2, RL.2.3, RL.2.5

A worked example

Read: "Noura put on her coat because the desert night was cold." Why did Noura put on her coat?

1. Find the word because. It tells us the reason.
2. The reason comes after because: the desert night was cold.

Because the desert night was cold.

Dates for Eid

On Friday morning, Maryam and her cousin Hamdan went with Grandmother to a date farm in Al Ain. The air was warm. The palm trees stood in long, straight rows. Grandmother wanted to pick dates to make sweets for Eid. Maryam carried a basket, and Hamdan held a small ladder.

"Pick only the soft, brown dates," said Grandmother. The children worked carefully and filled the basket. Soon it was heavy.

Then Hamdan saw a tired little bird sitting in the shade. It looked thirsty. He did not touch it. Instead, he called Grandmother, and she poured some water into a small dish. The bird drank, rested, and flew away.

"That was kind and gentle," said Grandmother. "When we help quietly, we make the world better."

The children carried the heavy basket home, smiling all the way.

Questions

1. Who went to the date farm with Grandmother?

   _____

2. Where is the date farm?

   _____

3. When did they go to the farm?

4. What did Grandmother want to make with the dates?

5. What did Hamdan hold while they worked?

6. What did Hamdan see in the shade?

7. Why did Grandmother pour water into a small dish?

8. How did the children pick the dates?

9. What happened after the bird drank?

10. Which sentence tells the main idea of the story: (a) Dates grow in Al Ain. (b) Two cousins helped a thirsty bird while they picked dates. (c) Eid sweets are made with dates.

11. What lesson does Grandmother teach at the end of the story?

12. Put these in the order they happen: the bird drinks water; the children pick dates; the children carry the basket home.

Section 3: Word meanings and how writers use words

Standards practised: L.2.4a, L.2.4b, L.2.4d, L.2.5b

A worked example

Read: "The path was narrow, so only one camel could walk on it at a time." What does narrow mean?

1. Look for clues near the word. Only one camel could fit on the path.
2. A path where only one fits is not wide.

Narrow means not wide.

Questions

1. "The soup was scalding. Layla waited because it could burn her tongue." What does scalding mean?

2. What does the word "unhappy" mean?

3. What does the word "unlock" mean?

4. What does the word "rewrite" mean?

5. Omar will reread his book tonight. What will he do?

6. Which two small words make the compound word "sandstorm"?

7. Which word is a compound word: sandy, sandcastle or sandal?

8. Which word means almost the same as "huge": tiny, giant or quiet?

9. Which word is the opposite of "empty": full, open or small?

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10. Put these words in order from least hot to most hot: boiling, warm, hot.

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11. Which word shows the fastest way to move: stroll, hurry or wander?

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12. Explain why "happy" and "unhappy" are opposites. What does the prefix do?

Section 4: Writing and language

Standards practised: L.2.1b, L.2.1f, L.2.2a, L.2.2b, L.2.2c, W.2.3

A worked example

Write the plural of the word "foot".

1. Most plurals add s, but some words change a different way.
2. We do not say foots. The word changes inside: foot becomes feet.

feet

Questions

1. Rewrite this sentence with the correct capital letters: omar visited abu dhabi on friday.

2. Add the missing comma to the end of this letter closing: Your friend

3. Rewrite with the correct capital letters: the children celebrated eid in sharjah.

4. Add the missing comma to the start of this letter: Dear Layla

5. Write "do not" as one word, using an apostrophe.

6. Write "we are" as one word, using an apostrophe.

7. Use an apostrophe to show that the bag belongs to Noura.

8. Write the plural of "child".

9. Write the plural of "tooth".

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10. Which is a complete sentence: (a) The big camel. (b) The camel drank water.

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11. Which sentence is the best way to make "The boy ran." longer: (a) The boy ran. (b) The happy boy ran quickly to the souq. (c) Ran quickly the.

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12. Put these sentences in order to tell a story: Finally he said thank you. First Salem washed his hands. Then Salem ate his lunch.

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Sounds, letters and decoding

1. bead (in "bread" the ea says a short e, and in "bear" it says air).
2. oa (the letters o and a work together to say a long o).
3. cart (the letters ar in both words make the same r-controlled sound).
4. hurt (ir and ur both make the same sound).
5. 2 (cam-el).
6. mar-ket.
7. un- (it comes at the start of the word and means not or the opposite).
8. -ful (it comes at the end of the word).
9. said (the ai in said makes a short e sound, not a long a).
10. jumped (wanted ends in the sound /id/ and played ends in /d/).
11. Go back and reread the sentence, looking at the word again, until it makes sense.

Section 2: Understanding what you read

1. Maryam and her cousin Hamdan.
2. In Al Ain.
3. On a Friday morning.
4. Sweets for Eid.
5. A small ladder.
6. A tired, thirsty little bird.
7. Because the bird looked thirsty.
8. Carefully (they picked only the soft, brown ones).
9. It rested and then flew away.
10. (b) (it tells what the whole story is about, not just one detail).
11. When we help others quietly and kindly, we make the world better (be kind and helpful).
12. 1. The children pick dates. 2. The bird drinks water. 3. The children carry the basket home.

Section 3: Word meanings and how writers use words

1. Very hot (the clue is that it could burn her tongue).
2. Not happy (the prefix un- means not).
3. To open a lock, to undo locking (the prefix un- means the opposite of).
4. To write again (the prefix re- means again).
5. Read his book again.
6. sand and storm.
7. sandcastle (it is made of sand and castle).
8. giant.
9. full.
10. warm, hot, boiling.
11. hurry (stroll and wander are relaxed ways of moving).
12. Un- means not, so unhappy means not happy, the opposite of happy.

Section 4: Writing and language

1. Omar visited Abu Dhabi on Friday.
2. Your friend,
3. The children celebrated Eid in Sharjah.
4. Dear Layla,
5. don't.
6. we're.
7. Noura's bag.
8. children.
9. teeth.
10. (b) (it tells who and what happened; (a) is only part of a sentence).
11. (b) (it adds a describing word, how he ran and where).
12. First Salem washed his hands. Then Salem ate his lunch. Finally he said thank you.